DEVELOPER HANDOFF

Ask Me Loader Experience

Implementation-ready summary for loader phases, states, typography, color, motion, interactions, and accessibility.

1. Phase sequence

#	Active label	Completed label	Duration
1	Understanding your request	Understood your request	3.4s
2	Running data queries	Data queries completed	6.0s
3	Charting the distribution	Distribution charted	5.4s
4	Generating insights	Insights generated	8.8s

> **Behavior:** One active phase at a time. Loader starts collapsed. Completed phases remain available when expanded. Do not show fake percentages or delay a ready response.

2. Required states

Pending
Muted icon/text; no animation.

Active
Blue animated glyph, shimmer title, elapsed time.

Complete
Stable checkmark, past-tense copy, no animation.

Retrying
Keep loader active and state that recovery is running.

Failed
Red icon/title, clear reason and next action; stop animation.

Stopped
Stop timers/tasks immediately; show restart or retry.

3. Type styles

UI: Inter · **Technical:** JetBrains Mono

Element	Style	Color
Loader/phase title	14px / 600	Slate 800
Agent heading	14px / 500 / 1.4	Slate 800
Narration	14px / 400 / 1.7	Slate 600
Supporting detail	12px / 400 / 1.5	Slate 500
Timer, values, code	12px / Mono	Slate 600–800
Metadata labels	10px / 500 / Mono	Slate 400

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4. Color tokens

Primary
#1E293B

Secondary
#475569

Tertiary
#64748B

Muted
#94A3B8

Border
#E2E8F0

Surface
#F8FAFC

Active
#2563EB

Error
#B4472B

5. Motion and layout

Item	Specification
Expand/collapse	160–320ms
Content fade	200–240ms
Active pulse	1.6s
Heading shimmer	2.6s
Header	10px gap; 8px top / 6px bottom padding
Phase row	9px gap; 6px vertical padding
Technical card	560px max; 10px radius; 10–14px padding

- Animate only the active phase.
- Stop animation after completion, failure, or cancellation.
- Support `prefers-reduced-motion`.
- Icon sizes: status/phase 16px, loader glyph 18px, composer actions 20px.

6. Interactions

Expand
Entire header is clickable. Add `aria-expanded` and preserve state during updates.

Stop
Visible only while active. Stops timer, transitions, and pending work.

Copy
Copy SQL/JSON only. Show “Copied” feedback for about 2 seconds.

Replay
Reset timer, phase, errors, copy feedback, and collapsed state.

7. Error behavior

Reference timeline: first error 6.0s → retry 8.8s → hard failure 11.8s → settled 12.6s.

> **Final message:** We couldn’t complete the data query after retrying. Check the data source connection or try again.

Keep raw errors and provider details inside expanded technical details. Never leave an active animation running after hard failure.

8. Responsive and accessibility

- Keep typography sizes unchanged on mobile.
- Use minimum 44×44px touch targets.
- Stack input/output cards vertically; allow code overflow scrolling.
- Provide keyboard access and visible focus for expand, stop, retry, replay, and copy.
- Announce phase changes using `aria-live="polite"`; do not announce the timer every second.

- Maintain 4.5:1 text contrast and never communicate status through color alone.

9. Acceptance checklist

- [ ] One active phase
- [ ] Accurate elapsed timer
- [ ] Past-tense completed copy
- [ ] Collapsed by default
- [ ] Expand works by keyboard
- [ ] Stop affects actual processing
- [ ] Replay fully resets state
- [ ] Copy feedback works
- [ ] Retry is clearly communicated
- [ ] Failure stops animation
- [ ] Reduced motion supported
- [ ] All deployed assets return 200